Request for Proposal

Brand Positioning, Strategy, Design

Proposals due January 24, 2025

Background

Cerebelly is committed to providing life-changing, superior nutrition for optimal cognitive development in children everywhere, setting a standard far above the industry. We craft our products from whole foods with organic, veggie-first ingredients and no added sugar. We proudly honor our Purity Award from Clean Label Project®, a third-party non-profit that tests levels of harmful heavy metals, chemicals, plastics, and pesticides.

Our story began with our founder—a neurosurgeon, developmental neurobiologist, and mother of three. While pursuing her PhD in neurobiology at Stanford, she researched treatments for pediatric brain cancer, sparking a deep interest in the nutritional factors that optimally develop the brain.

As a neurobiologist, she knew a baby needs crucial nutrients during their first year, when the brain doubles in size, and during the first five years, when the brain reaches 80% of its development. And as a mother, she knew that every parent needs the convenience of pre-made food for their children. But trips to the baby food aisle revealed a glaring gap in the market—most baby purees provided only 2-4 of the 16 key nutrients her research identified as essential for brain development. Collaborating with her brother, together they created Cerebelly, a baby food product that far surpassed nutrient density on the market and redefined the industry standard for clean, nourishing food for children.

Today Cerebelly is a major baby food brand, but with stiff competition. We have a wide retail distribution in 15,000+ doors and a very robust online e-commerce business with about 10,000 active product subscriptions between our website and Amazon. Many of our competitors focus on fruit-first, highly sweet baby foods that are very appetizing, but introduce too much sweetness and not enough nutrition into babies' diets too early. There is also heavy competition in the organic and premium segment of the baby food market. While a core differentiator is that every Cerebelly SKU contains a patented blend of 16 key brain-supporting nutrients (Cerebelly has 8x the nutrients of conventional baby foods), we have a tendency to get lost in the product attribute details in our communications. Our products can be bundled by age but because they don't have to be, the science-heavy messaging gets really confusing for new parents. We lack adequate differentiation between veggie, bone broth, and smoothie products in our portfolio, and parents often ask what's the difference.

Key competitors include:

- Serenity Kids
- Once Upon a Farm
- Brainiac

As the most nutrient-rich baby food available, combined with being the only baby food with the essential nutrients to optimize the development of the brain, Cerebelly needs to strengthen its competitive positioning, differentiation, and messaging to stand out as different and better in a crowded category and help parents make choices in their baby's best interest for brain and dietary development.

Objectives

We are trying to accomplish the following from this brand positioning initiative:

- Strike a strong emotional chord between our brand and the target audience
- Clarify and strengthen the brand's ownable positioning in the market to win share
- Develop a guided path for parents as they journey through the baby feeding lifecycle
- Secure substantial consumer preference for our products vs. alternatives
- Refine our target audience and better understand their motivating insights for our brand
- Guide product development with the highest growth ideas for renovation and innovation
- Improve brand creative and content consistency across touchpoints to elevate equity

This brand positioning initiative is intended to directly impact the following:

- Increase brand awareness, brand equity, trial, loyalty, and sales growth
- Drive higher shelf velocity for our existing retail distribution
- Build confidence with retail buyers to hold and increase our distribution
- Improve the engagement, efficiency, and impact of our brand advertising
- Improve the sales success and longevity of our new product launches

Scope

The following elements are included in our brand positioning roadmap. Some or all of these could be conducted with the same external agency partner, but some of them might be best suited for specialty partners with unique capabilities.

- **Brand Architecture**
    - Core, foundational brand pillars, which could include: *Category, Belief, Purpose, Promise, Mission, Values, Vision, Personality, Pursuits*, etc.
- **Brand Strategy**
    - *Consumer target* - refine the precise target audience to position the brand for meaningful growth and competitive advantage
    - *Value proposition* - a unique articulation of how we add value for the consumer
    - *Competitive differentiation* - articulation of our differences and superiority, and how do we leverage category certifications and claims
    - *Brand voice* - how we will stand out in a crowded market with what we say
- **Brand Design**

    - *Brand identity refresh* - including a new take on logo, colors, fonts, etc.
    - *Style guide* - an updated guide for all brand creative that reflects the identity
- **Product Packaging**
    - *Package design* - a fresh design for packaging that amplifies the brand
    - *Shelf differentiators* - how we use color, callouts, and packaging formats for stop-ability and shop-ability
    - *Claims* - what facts, certifications, claims, and copy we emphasize and how
- **Website Design**
    - Updating the brand website to reflect the new brand
- **Brand Campaign & Content**
    - *Campaign themes* - campaign ideas, headlines, taglines that capture attention
    - *Brand messaging* - copy, claims, and supporting selling points
    - *Creative content* - product photography, lifestyle photography, video assets
- **Product Innovation**
    - *Innovation strategy* - how our portfolio evolution over time will set us apart
    - *Innovation map* - determine the best opportunities for innovation investment across our existing portfolio (line extensions) and beyond (brand expansions)

Budget

While we do have a placeholder in our budget to cover our brand initiatives, the final budget for this project will be largely influenced by the scope of items included and the strengths of the agency partner selected. At this stage, each prospective agency is requested to provide projected budgets based on the breadth of areas covered in their proposal along with a breakdown of major portions of the budget so that we can determine if it makes sense to include some but not all items.

Projected Timeline

- **Request for Proposal sent to prospective partners** (*by January 3, 2025*)
    - For any questions during the proposal stage and for submitting final proposals, please contact Cerebelly CMO Taylor West: taylor.west@cerebelly.com
    - We encourage prospective partners to have conversations with our team that can help them develop the most robust proposal
- **Proposal submissions received by Cerebelly** *(by January 24, 2025)*
    - We'll need to schedule time to review the proposal together
- **Agency selection** *(by February 7, 2025)*
    - Follow-up conversations and reviews of agreements drafts will be conducted after proposals are received and before a decision is made
- **Project kickoff** *(by February 15, 2025)*

    - Official kickoff with a staffed agency team to begin work
    - Build a timeline to incorporate:
        - Consumer research
        - Brand architecture, strategy, positioning, and messaging development
        - Brand design
        - Packaging design
        - Website design
        - Any other components included in the scope of work

Proposals

Please include the following in your proposal:

- **Agency introduction**
  Who you are, what you do well, what makes you different, what types of clients are an ideal fit for your agency, how you work, where you are located, etc. Please include any client examples that echo some of our similar challenges and situations to give us a better idea of your fit for our project.
- **Core capabilities**
  A summary of the services your agency provides, particularly matching up your capabilities where there is overlap with what we are hoping to tackle in this project
- **Initial Cerebelly impressions**
  Some of your first, candid thoughts about our brand and product line and how you could be the right fit to partner with us to tackle our challenges
- **Proposal details**
  A summary of the deliverable scope, areas covered from our brand initiative list above, estimated costs, estimated timeline, and other pertinent details
- **Additional considerations**
  Any thoughts or ideas you encourage us to think about that we might not have covered or contemplated in this RFP
- **Agency team**
  Who are some of the key players (known individuals or simply roles that will be staffed) that we could potentially work with if we collaborated together
- **Contacts**
  Key contacts and contact information for this RFP process from your agency